

put in so that it will select all of the text. We've put in 3 pixels as the value. Press [Shift] + [Ctrl] + [I] and press [Delete]. Press [Ctrl] + [D] to

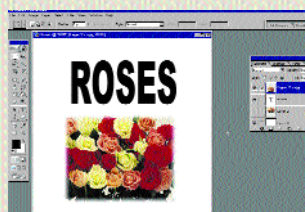
deselect. Add a soft drop shadow by choosing Drop Shadow from the Layer Style. That completes the metallic effect.

WORKING WITH LAYERS

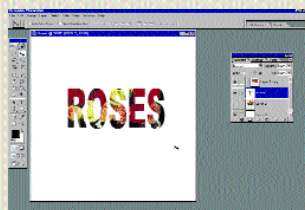
Managing layers more efficiently

Grouping: an excellent bridge

Grouping layers essentially lets you move one object within another. Press [Alt] and in the Layers palette, click between



The two objects before grouping



The two objects after grouping

the layers you want to group. In the figure, first and second layer are shown individually and after grouping.

Rotate through the Blend modes

It is a test of your patience when you try to get the right effects in the layer Blend modes because you have to go back to the Blend mode drop down menu every time. There's a simpler way to do this: simply press [Shift] + [-] or [+] to go to the

previous or next Blend mode.

Organising related layers

If you need to work on several layers simultaneously, you can keep them in sync by clicking the 'Create a new set' button in the Layers palette and dragging and dropping the related layers in Set Layer. Else, you can link the layers—hold down the [Alt] key and from the Layer palette's drop-down menu, choose New Set From Linked.

You can also keep related data in a more accessible format by pressing [Alt] and double-clicking on the layer. In the Layer Properties dialog box, choose a colour and click OK. This will colour the left side of that layer in the Layers palette and make it easier for visual identification. Apply the same colour to all related layers.

Moving multiple layers between documents

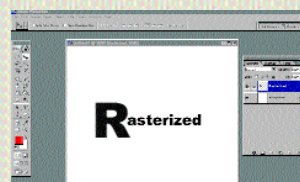
To move more than one layer at a time from one document to another, link your layers and make sure you drag your layer from within the document itself rather than dragging from the Layers palette. If you drag it from the Layers palette, you can only get one layer at a time.

Applying the same style across layers

You have a style which you want to apply to all the layers but the thought of doing the tedious action is bugging you? Simply link all the layers to which you want to apply the same style. Then under the Layer menu, go to Layer Style and choose Copy Layer Style. Go back to the Layer menu and choose Paste Layer Style to Linked, and your copied style(s) will instantly be applied to all the linked layers.

Selecting a letter after the Type layer has been rasterised

To do this, just make a loose selection using the Lasso tool around the letter. Hold down the [Ctrl] key and press the Up Arrow key once



The selected letter can be tweaked as required

and then the Down Arrow key once. The letter will be selected without disturbing anything else on the layer. Now you can play with this letter as it is now a 'floating selection'.

Preventing Layer styles from affecting your new work

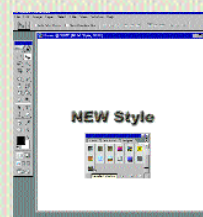
Layer styles apply to all the elements in the layer. For example, if you apply a

Bevel and Emboss to everything you do, every layer will have to be applied to it. If you avoid this, create a blank layer by clicking the New Layer icon and drag this new layer over your Bevel and Emboss layer and press [Ctrl] + [E] to merge it. This will remove the active effect from the layer so it no longer has Bevel and Emboss. New things on that

Creating your own styles

If you have created a masterpiece of art and use it in your future work, you can do so by saving it as a Style.

Open the Layer log box (double-click



Using your own styles when you want

effect on that layer (Layers palette) and click the New Style button in the Style dialog box where you can name the style. To apply this style to the Window menu, choose Show Style palette. The style you just created will appear as the last style in the palette.